

FOR LITTLE EXPLORERS

# Sorting Socks

*How can we sort a jumble of socks?*

READ ALOUD

**Tumble, tumble, plop!** (Pretend a soft sock lands in your lap.) *Big Wonderer tips a basket of clean socks onto the rug. Little Wonderer sees stripes, dots, stars, and many colors.*

*A jumble is easier to understand when we choose one thing to notice. First they look at color. Blue socks go together. Yellow socks go together.*

ASK **Can you point to two socks that share a color?**

*Next they look at patterns. Stripes join stripes. Dots join dots. Stars join stars.* **One rule at a time!** (Trace pretend stripes in the air.)

*Then they compare size. A small sock may look like a big sock, but a matching pair needs the same size, color, and pattern.* ASK **Which sock looks biggest?**

*Little Wonderer places each match side by side. Pair by pair, the jumble becomes tidy groups. One striped sock is left alone.*

ASK **Where might its matching sock be?**

*Big Wonderer finds it peeking from the empty basket. The last pair clicks together. Sorting helped them look closely and find every match.*

Inside: a sorting story · color, pattern, and size · first-then-last · spot the difference · a maze · counting to 20 · shapes and colors · rhymes and letter sounds · tracing and snipping · a coloring page · and a fold-up picture book.

# A tumble of socks



## Look at the whole jumble

*Clean socks tumble onto the rug. Some are blue, some are yellow, and some are red. Some have stripes, dots, or stars.*

**ASK** Point to two socks that look different. What do you notice?



## Choose one sorting rule

*Big and Little Wonderer begin with color. Looking for just one thing makes the jumble easier to sort.*

**ASK** Follow the blue socks with your finger. Can you find the yellow group?



## Match the details

*A pair has the same size, color, and pattern. The Wonderers place each matching pair side by side.*

**ASK** Can you find the pair with stripes?

**TRY IT WITH A GROWN-UP** First, choose four clean socks with your grown-up. Then, sort them by one thing you can see: color, pattern, or size.

# What can a sorter notice?

*Sorting means making groups by a rule. The same socks can make new groups when the rule changes.*




## Look at color

*Blue can go with blue. Yellow can go with yellow. Ignore the patterns while color is the rule.*




## Look at pattern

*Stripes can go with stripes. Dots can go with dots. A pattern repeats across the cloth.*




## Look at size

*Small socks can make one group and big socks another. Put them side by side to compare.*



## A pair shares every detail

*Two socks can share one detail without being a pair. A matching pair has the same size, color, and pattern.*

ASK **Point to a matching pair. How can you tell?**

(Real socks can also feel different. Today we are sorting by what we can see.)

**Change the rule.** *Sort the same socks by color, then mix them and sort by pattern. The socks stay the same, but their groups can change.*

EXPERIMENT WITH A GROWN-UP First, set out six clean socks with your grown-up. Then, choose one rule and make groups. Last, mix and try a different rule.

# Match each sock to a basket

*Three socks and three baskets. Match each sock to the basket with the same color.*

## 1 Use your finger to join each sock to the basket of the same color.



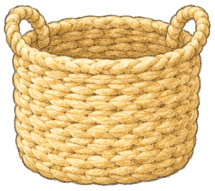
a blue sock



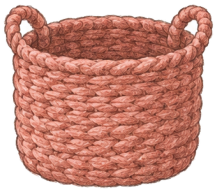
a yellow sock



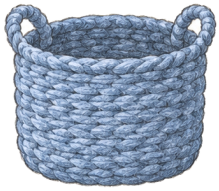
a red sock



a yellow basket



a red basket



a blue basket

**WHY?** These pictures match by color. A different sorting rule could make different groups.

## 2 Shapes and colors on the socks

Point to each shape, then say its color with your grown-up.



**blue circle**

A blue dot looks like a circle.



**yellow triangle**

A yellow point looks like a triangle.



**red square**

A red patch looks like a square.



**green oval**

A green heel patch looks like an oval.

**ASK** Can you find something round in your room?

# What happened first?

Grown-up: point to each picture and tell it in a few words. Tell the story together using First, Then, and Last. Little explorer circles 1, 2 or 3 under each picture.

## 1 From jumble to color groups



1 2 3



1 2 3



1 2 3

First, socks tumble out. Then, choose color. Last, make color groups.

## 2 Make the matching pairs



1 2 3



1 2 3



1 2 3

First, sort patterns. Then, match details. Last, stack the pairs.

**TALK ABOUT IT** What other things could you sort into groups?

# Spot 5 differences

The two pictures look the same, but 5 things changed. Point to each one, then circle it in the bottom picture. Color a dot for each one you find.



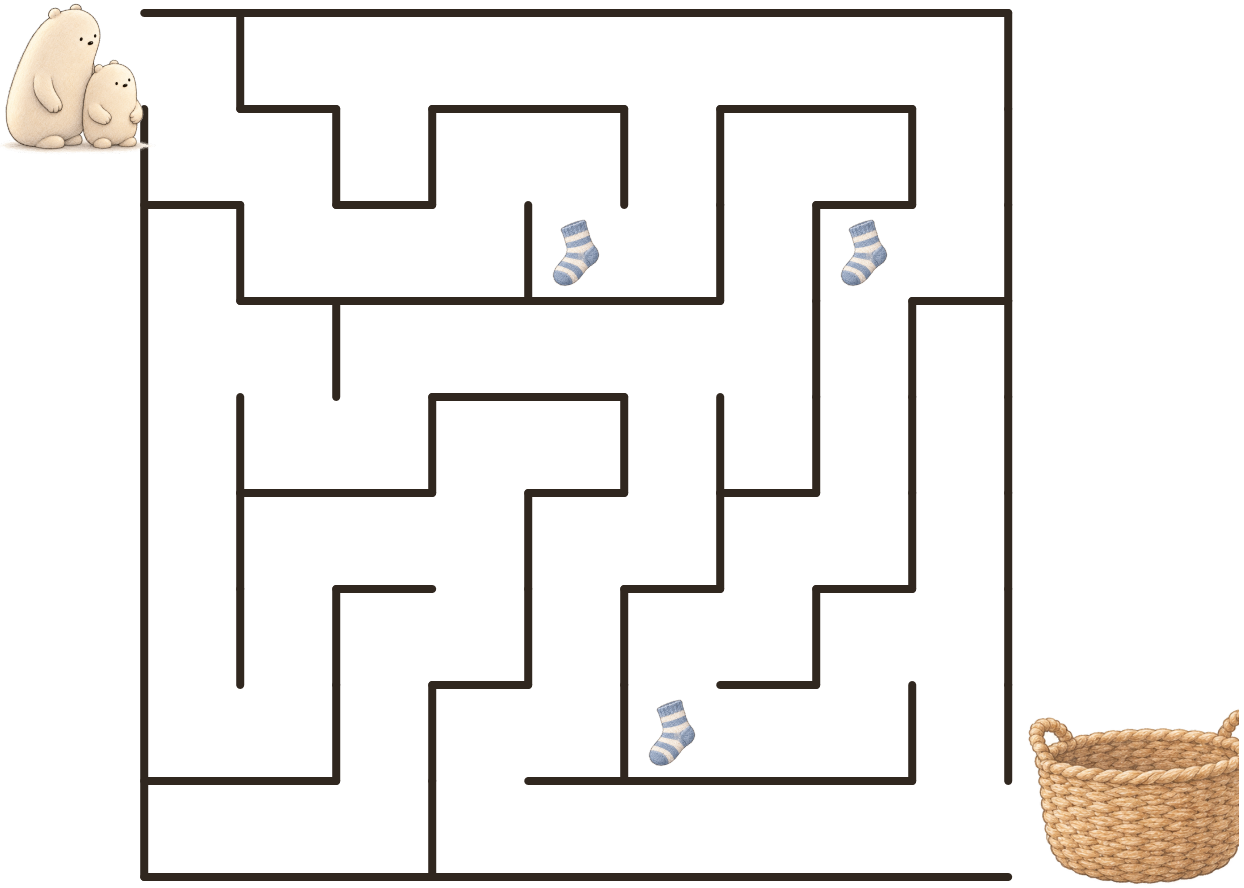


I found: ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

# Follow the sock path

*Big and Little Wonderer are carrying a sock to the basket. Help them find the way and spot the three striped socks along the path.*

**First,** trace the way with a finger.
**Then,** touch each striped sock as you pass it.
**Last,** follow the way again with your finger.

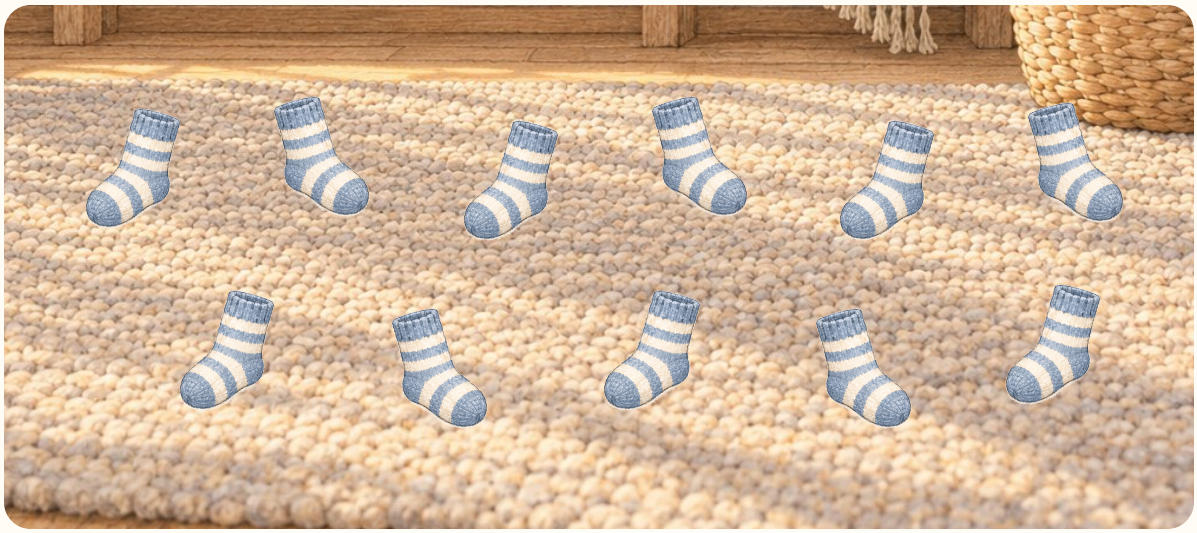


Striped socks spotted:

**WHY MAKE GROUPS?** A sorting rule helps us notice how things are alike. It can also help us see which thing does not belong in a group.

# Sock basket count

## 1 Count the socks. Circle how many.



Touch each sock once as you count. Put a crayon dot on each sock you touch.

9 10 11 13

## 2 Count the socks. Circle the number.

One full frame is 10. Then count on: 11, 12...



12 13 15

## 3 Count the socks. Circle the number.

10 and some more.



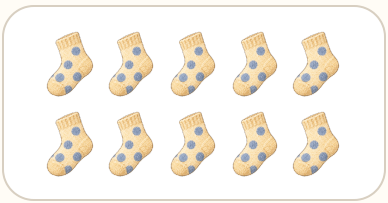
16 18 20

## 4 Find the number 14. Circle it.

9 14 17 20 11

## 5 Point to the group with MORE.





# Sock picture stories

A stretch, just for fun. Grown-up reads each little story. Count the first group, then count on with the second group. Little explorer circles the answer.

*2 blue socks rest on the rug. 3 more socks tumble down. How many socks now?*



2 + 3 = (4) (5) (6)

*4 striped socks sit by one basket. 4 striped socks sit by another. How many striped socks?*



4 + 4 = (7) (8) (9)

*5 dotted socks make one group. Then 6 more dotted socks join. How many dotted socks?*



5 + 6 = (10) (11) (12)

*10 star socks fill the frame. 5 more star socks join them. How many star socks?*



10 + 5 = (14) (15) (17)

# Sock sounds and rhymes

**S s** This is the letter S, s. It says /s/, like the start of sock. Point to each S, s together.

**1** **Which pictures start with /s/, like *sock*? Circle them.**


sock


sun


snail


cat


hat


bug

**2** **Rhyme time! Grown-up says the three words. Point to the two that rhyme.**


cat


hat


sun


bug


rug


sock


rock


sock


tree

**3** **Read it together. Point to each word as you say it.**


A cat sits by a hat.



A bug sits on a rug.


**4** **Just for fun: touch each letter, then say the word fast.**


c a t


b u g

# Trace and snip

Count the pictures together. Trace the first number with a finger, then trace the dotted numbers with a crayon. Start at the dot.



1 1 1 1



2 2 2 2



3 3 3 3



4 4 4 4



5 5 5 5

## Snip to the sock basket

With a grown-up helping, snip along the wavy line from the sock to the basket. Safety scissors, and a grown-up holds the paper.







# Color the sock sort

**First,** color the big striped sock blue.
**Then,** color the little dotted sock any color you like.
**Last,** circle the sock with a star.

Try to stay inside the lines. Big and Little Wonderer can be any color you like.



# Sorting Socks

FOR LITTLE EXPLORERS



How can we sort this sock jumble?





Clean socks tumble onto the rug.





Choose one rule. Start with color.





Blue joins blue. Yellow joins yellow.





Now stripes join stripes.





Compare big socks and small socks.





Match every detail to make pairs.





Pair by pair, the jumble is sorted.

# How to fold the picture book

1. Print the picture sheet on one page, landscape, at 100% (no scaling).
2. Fold it in half the long way, then open it. Fold it in half the short way, then in half again; open it flat.
3. **Grown-up only:** fold it in half the short way and cut along the middle fold from the folded edge to the center crease.
4. Open it, fold it the long way again, and push the ends together so the slit opens into a little book. Page 1 goes on the front.

*Read it together: one picture, a few words on each page. Ask "what do you see?" before you turn the page.*